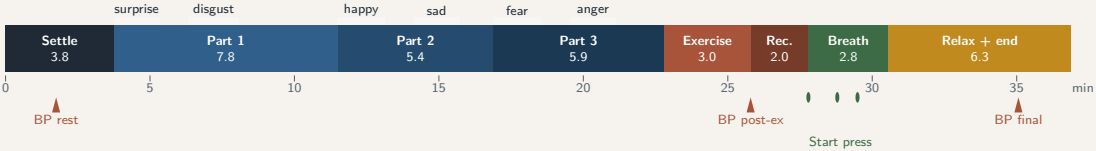
Meridian session protocol (v26): one participant, start to finish

34 steps | ≈**37 min recorded** (≈38 in practice) | ≈67 min per participant with ≈30 min setup and consent



Getting settled 0:00–3:45 | **3.8 min**		Part 1: low HR 3:45–11:30 | **7.8 min**		Part 2: mid HR 11:30–16:53 | **5.4 min**		Part 3: highest HR 16:53–22:48 | **5.9 min**	
Sensor and sync check	0:30	Clip: surprise (90 s)	1:35	Clip: happy (93 s)	1:38	Clip: fear (95 s)	1:40
PANAS mood (start)	1:15	Rating (SAM + emotion)	0:40	Rating	0:40	Rating	0:40
Resting baseline, eyes open, BP	2:00	Neutral washout	0:20	Neutral washout	0:20	Neutral washout	0:20
TIPI personality: at consent	–	Clip: disgust (100 s)	1:45	Clip: sad (90 s)	1:35	Clip: anger (90 s)	1:35
		Rating	0:40	Rating	0:40	Rating	0:40
		Stroop *or* N-back	1:30	Return-to-baseline gate	≥0:30	Word list: study + recognise	∼1:00
		NASA-TLX workload	0:45			Read aloud (147 words)	∼1:00
		Return-to-baseline gate	≥0:30				

Heart-rate elevation 22:48–25:48 | **3.0 min**		Recovery 25:48–27:48 | **2.0 min**		Controlled breathing 27:48–30:34 | **2.8 min**		Relaxation and end 30:34–36:54 | **6.3 min**	
Stand-to-sit, as many as possible	1:00	Seated rest, BP after exertion	2:00	Paced breathing 6/min	1:00	Guided body scan (audio)	4:30
Step-up on 20–30 cm step	2:00	heart-rate recovery at 1 and 2 min		Paced breathing 20/min	0:42	Return to normal, final BP	0:20
operator counts reps and steps				Box breathing 4-4-4-4, 4 rounds	1:04	PANAS mood (end)	1:15
				each starts on a Start press		Session complete	0:15

Clip order: fixed, calmest to most HR-raising. Ranked by mean heart-rate change in a 202-study meta-analysis (Siegel 2018): disgust d=0.07, happy 0.33, sad 0.36, fear 0.49, anger 0.52; surprise gives a brief slow-down. Clips trimmed to 90–100 s.

One cognitive task per participant. Stroop for participants 1–6, 13–18, . . . ; N-back (0:50) for 7–12, 19–24, ... **Gates** wait for HR within 5 bpm and skin conductance within 10% of baseline for 15 s.

Safety: screening skips both exercises for heart, breathing, mobility, pregnancy or "unwell" answers. **Sensors:** ECG, finger PPG, skin conductance, EMG, two face cameras, thermal, Wi-Fi CSI, stereo audio.